use of violence against civilian populations to achieve political ends." This definition would serve as the basis for future legislation and for the required regulation. The organization's source of authority would be a convention agreed upon by its founders. The body would include international experts in a variety of fields and would examine the involvement of both countries and organizations in terrorism. A "scale of involvement" would be established to define the type and extent of a country's involvement, and an updated list of countries involved in terrorism, according to these indices, would be published periodically. The body would support the need and the obligation to punish countries for their involvement in terrorism, and a clear and fixed "price scale" would define the penalty to be paid by the country in question. This price scale would be adapted to the various types of involvement, with the aim of changing these countries' balance of interests and convincing them of the futility of supporting terrorism. A secondary boycott would be imposed on states and economic bodies that continued to maintain economic and other ties, whether secretly or openly, with countries that had been boycotted for their involvement in terrorism. Finally, a permanent international counterterrorism mechanism would be established, one of whose objectives would be to supervise the implementation of punitive measures against the countries involved in terrorism and to warn of any deviations on their part.

Israel was the first to propose, years ago, from international platforms, the idea of establishing such a body. President Chaim Herzog spoke about this at the UN, and Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin not only expressed support for the idea but actually delved into the structure, objectives, and tools such an organization would have.

So, if I am asked whether it is possible to eliminate terrorism, my answer would be that if all or most of the steps I have listed above are taken, there is definitely a high probability that the community of free nations will succeed in reducing international terrorism to a level that is tolerable.

Iran: A Personal Perspective

My acquaintance with Iran and the Iranians began in mid-1965, about a year and a half after I had begun my service in the Mossad. One morning, I